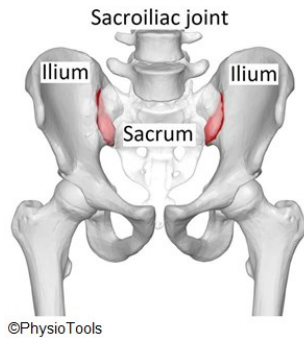


Sacroiliac joint pain



Sacroiliac joint (SIJ) pain

The Sacroiliac joints are at the very bottom of your spine. They make up your pelvis complex with the pubic symphysis located at the front of the pelvis. The SIJ are essential for load transfer between the legs and the spine. This role requires the joints to be very stable and allow little movement. Due to their stability the SIJ are not a common cause for back pain. They can become painful during pregnancy due to hormones and increased load. Trauma, such as a fall can cause pain. Patients with structural abnormalities such as scoliosis may develop pain in these joints. Conditions including osteoarthritis, or inflammatory back pain called spondyloarthropathy can cause SIJ pain. Unusual causes could be infection, gout or tumours.

Features of inflammatory back pain/spondyloarthropathy include

If you have 3 or more of the features below, you should discuss with your GP or Physiotherapist:

- Slow or gradual onset of stiffness over weeks or months with persistent symptoms for more than 3 months.
- Stiffness felt in your spine/ joints. This is worse after prolonged rest or first thing in the morning after sleep.
- Feeling better after activity and worse after rest.
- You may be more likely to have Inflammatory back pain if you have inflammation in other areas of your body. Do you have Inflammatory bowel disease, Psoriasis or certain eye conditions (uveitis, iritis). Any history of tendon inflammation (enthesitis) such as Achilles tendon or patella tendon.
- Onset of pain before the age of 45
- usually starts affecting people under the age of 35.
- Spondyloarthropathy can also have a genetic factor . If you have a first degree relative with spondyloarthritis there may be a genetic link.
- Waking during the second half of the night because of symptoms.
- Buttock pain
- Non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs(NSAIDs) improve your symptoms.

SIJ/back pain is usually a self-limiting condition. It is usually not a serious condition.. It will usually get better with physiotherapy, pain killers and time. Exercise such as walking, cycling and swimming will be beneficial when you have pain. Avoid prolonged rest. Below are some simple stretches and advice to try and help reduce symptoms.



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Stand upright and gently move your weight until you find your natural balance. keep your weight equal between your legs and avoid reducing weight on your affected side.



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Lying with your knees bent and your feet on the floor.

Lift the knee on your affected side towards your chest. Place your hands behind the knee and draw it into your chest. Hold 5 secs.

Repeat 10 times.



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Lying on your back with knees bent.

arch your pelvis forwards so that your back lifts off the resting surface. hold for 5 seconds. then reverse this movement and flatten your back against the resting surface hold for 5 seconds.

Repeat 10 times.



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Resting position lying on your side (unaffected side)

Straighten the leg below. Support the leg on the affected side with pillows.

If symptoms continue, SIJ injections or Rhizolysis may be an option. Rhizolysis involves heating the nerves with radiofrequency. Surgical treatment may be discussed for persistent chronic symptoms, such as a fusion.

For further information

Please email ghnt.newcastlegatesheadtims@nhs.net, ring on **0191 2138800** or visit our website at: www.tims.nhs.uk which provides online guidance and support on managing your musculoskeletal (MSK) condition effectively.

The NHS website also provides trusted online information and guidance on all aspects of health and healthcare to help you manage your condition and/or inform your choices about your health: www.nhs.uk.

Useful links

The Patient Advice and Liaison Service (PALS) can offer on-the-spot advice and information about the NHS. You can contact them on freephone **0800 032 02 02** or e-mail northoftynepals@nhct.nhs.uk.



Tyneside Integrated Musculoskeletal Service

TIMS is a partnership between Newcastle upon Tyne Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust and Gateshead Health NHS Foundation Trust

Information provided by **Rachel Nicholson**, Senior Physiotherapist

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